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handmade crochet patterns

No-Sew Christmas Gnome

A plump little gnome worked as ONE continuous piece - body, beard, face and hat all in one tube with simple colour changes and a popcorn nose. Nothing to sew.

Perfect first amigurumi and a fast market-season make.

UK terms

Beginner

1 - 2 hours



FINISHED SIZE

- About 11-12.5 cm (4.5-5 in) tall in worsted / aran on a 3.5 mm hook.
- About 5 cm (2 in) wide at the base.
- One piece - no assembly, no sewing.

Design Code NS X01

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PATTERN OVERVIEW

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The nose sits on the round BEFORE the hat-band colour change. Before R14, mark the front of the face (count 14 sts from your round start); the bobble lands between rounds 16 and 17 of the body - centred under the eyes you will place one round above it.

UK terms · Beginner · 1 - 2 hours

SAFETY FIRST

If you add safety eyes they are small parts and a choking hazard: lock the washers from the inside BEFORE stuffing and closing, and pull-test. For babies and under-3s, embroider the eyes or leave the face plain - the gnome reads perfectly with just a nose.

Not tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). Stuff firmly, weave every end in at least 5 cm, and do not market finished gnomes as baby-safe.

MATERIALS

- Body + hat yarn: worsted / aran (#4), 40-50 g, red or green.
- Beard yarn: worsted or fluffy white, 10-15 g.
- Face yarn: skin tone, about 10 g.
- Optional: dark yarn for embroidered eyes, or 2 x 6-8 mm safety eyes.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E-4) - or whatever size makes a dense, no-see-through fabric.
- Stuffing: fibre fill about 20-30 g.
- Notions: stitch marker, tapestry needle, scissors.

GAUGE

Gauge is not critical - aim for a firm fabric (about 10-11 dc x 11 rounds = 5 cm). If stuffing shows through, go down half a millimetre.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring

ch chain

sl st slip stitch

tr double crochet

dtr treble crochet

inc increase (2 tr in one st)

dc2tog double crochet 2 together (a decrease)

BO 5-dtr bobble (counts as 1 st)

FO fasten off

st(s) stitch(es)

R round

(n) stitch count at round end

CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

Worked in continuous rounds (do not join, do not chain 1 between rounds) from the base up: body colour, then white beard, then skin-tone face, then the hat in the body colour. Mark the first stitch of every round and move the marker up. Change colours on the final pull-through of the last stitch of the old colour.

1. The magic ring

Wrap yarn around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop and work the first round into the ring; pull the tail tight once the round is complete.

2. Working in a spiral

No joins and no starting chains - keep going round after round. The colour-change lines will slant very slightly; that is the no-sew look.

3. The 5-tr bobble

Yarn over, insert hook in the stitch, pull up a loop, yarn over and pull through 2 loops (incomplete tr). Repeat 4 more times in the same stitch (6 loops on hook). Yarn over and pull through all 6 loops. One bobble counts as ONE stitch and pops the nose.

4. dc2tog decrease

Insert hook, pull up a loop; insert in the next stitch, pull up a loop (3 loops on hook). Yarn over and pull through all 3. On visible rounds use an invisible decrease instead if you prefer.

5. Clean colour changes

Work the last stitch of the old colour until 2 loops remain, then pull the new colour through. Give both yarns a gentle tug to keep the join tight.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Body, beard, face & hat - one piece

Start in the body colour (red or green). The R15-16 line, where you switch back to the body colour, forms the hat edge - no folding, no sewing.

Body - body colour

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 dc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[dc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 dc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 dc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6-8	dc in each st around (3 rnd)	(30)	-

Beard - white (R9-12)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R9-12	dc in each st around (4 rnd)	(30)	-

Face & nose - skin tone (R13-15)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R13	dc in each st around	(30)	-

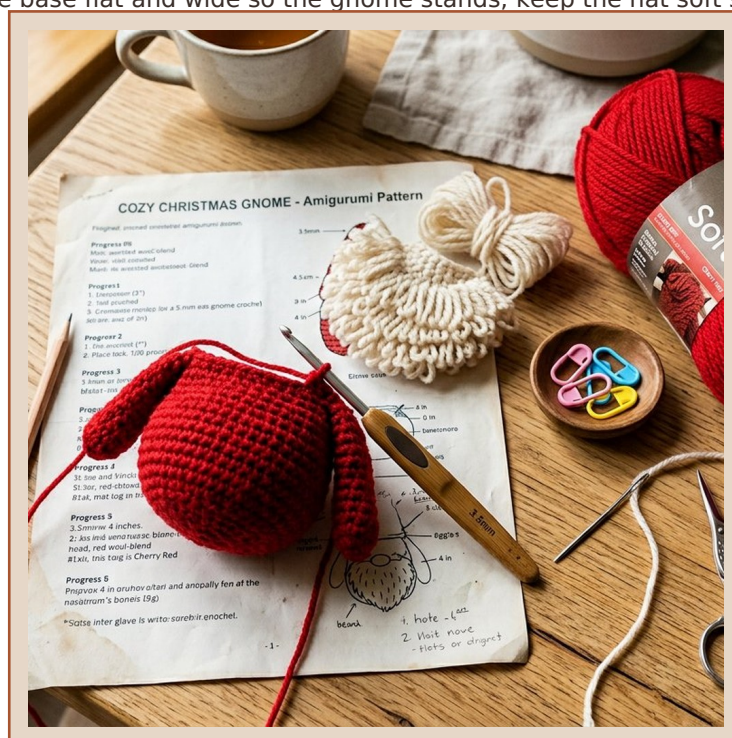
Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R14	dc in next 14, BO in next st (nose), dc in remaining 15	(30)	bobble = nose
R15	dc in each st around	(30)	-

Hat - body colour (R16-23)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R16	dc in each st around	(30)	hat edge forms here
R17	[3 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(24)	-
R18	dc in each st around	(24)	-
R19	[2 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(18)	start stuffing
R20	dc in each st around	(18)	-
R21	[dc, dc2tog] x 6	(12)	-
R22	dc in each st around	(12)	top up stuffing
R23	dc2tog x 6	(6)	close

Finish: stuff firmly, adding more before the opening closes. FO with a 15 cm tail, thread through the front loops of the last 6 stitches, pull closed and weave in.

Stuffing shape: pack the base flat and wide so the gnome stands; keep the hat soft so it flops a little.



On the hook - what your rounds should look like as they grow

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Hat brim (optional): join white yarn at the R15-16 colour-change line and work sl st around. FO and weave in - it covers the change line neatly.
- Eyes (optional): 2 embroidered straight stitches or 6-8 mm safety eyes, 1-3 stitches apart, one round above the nose. Lock safety-eye washers BEFORE stuffing and closing the hat tip.

- Extra beard texture: a few surface sl sts or short tied strands of white over R9-12.
- Hanging ornament: ch 18 at the hat tip and sl st into the same place to form a loop. FO and weave in.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Colour lines slant noticeably.**

That is the spiral's true line - put the slant at the back. Or join each colour with a sl st and ch 1 for perfectly level stripes, at the cost of a visible seam.

- **The nose bobble will not pop.**

Work the 5 tr loosely and push the bobble toward you as you complete it; finish the round, then nudge it out from the inside while stuffing.

- **Gnome tips over.**

Pack more stuffing into the base and flatten the bottom; the base disc should be noticeably firmer than the hat.

COLORWAYS



Santa red



Forest green



Nordic grey



Candy pink



Midnight navy

HELPFUL TIPS

Size variations

Mini ornament: DK yarn + 3 mm hook. Work R1-R21 (12 sts), stuff firmly, SKIP R22 and work R23: dc2tog around (6), then close as usual - about 8-9 cm tall.

Large decoration: chunky yarn + 5 mm hook. Work R6-8 twice (6 straight body rounds instead of 3) before starting the beard at R9 - about 15 cm tall. Stitch counts are unchanged.

- Why dc2tog here: on a one-piece gnome, neatness matters less than grip - dc2tog pulls the fabric firm against the stuffing. Your needle inside the hat tip is impossible to poke with an invisible decrease, so the classic decrease is deliberate.

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Safety reminder

This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). If you use safety eyes, lock the washers before stuffing and closing; for young children, embroider the face or leave it plain.

Happy crocheting!

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